

March 12, 2025

NITRE National Coordination Office
Attention: Faisal D'Souza
2415 Eisenhower Avenue
Alexandria, VA 22314

Dear Mr. D'Souza:

UnitedHealth Group (UHG) appreciates this opportunity to share our insights around enhancing artificial intelligence (AI) innovation and solutions in the health care sector with you. We support the Trump Administration's interest in leveraging innovations in AI technology to improve consumer experience and drive America's economic growth. At UHG, we believe AI solutions can be utilized to empower our patients, members, and providers with better insights, more timely information, and better care experiences, while keeping safety, privacy, and transparency at the forefront of our thinking. Across our organization, we are evaluating how AI can facilitate claims processing, answer members' simple questions, enrich clinician-patient interactions, and above all, enhance care delivery. Within our distinct businesses, which together span the care continuum, we're committed to deploying AI applications at scale, so members, patients, providers, and consumers alike can realize their benefits.

UHG is a mission-driven organization dedicated to helping people live healthier lives and helping make the healthcare system work better for everyone through two distinct business platforms- UnitedHealthcare, our health benefits business, and Optum, our health service business. We work with employers, providers, and governments to serve people and share a vision of a value-based system of care that provides compassionate and equitable care. We are committed to a future where every person has access to high-quality, affordable health care and a modern, high-performing health system that reduces disparities, improves outcomes, and lessens the burden of disease.

Our Responsible AI Vision

To make health care work smarter for our members, patients, providers, and consumers, we've built a team of world-class AI experts from around the globe, including premier researchers and thinkers across medical, academic and private organizations, along with external partners, to responsibly and safely deploy AI innovation at scale. Through our Responsible AI (RAI) program, we consider, identify, and address potential risk of unintended consequences that could impact our members, patients, or consumers.

Human at the Center

Our commitment to using AI solutions to enhance human decision-making is built on the principles of safety and responsibility. First, AI does not replace the health care provider's decision; it enables it. Second, our work is insights-led, as we leverage AI solutions to help solve the highest priority business problems focused on administrative and operational efficiency.

Finally, we always include a human in decision-making, so the AI solution provides insights but does not make the final decision.

RAI Board as Cornerstone

The cornerstone of our RAI program is a RAI Board which is comprised of clinicians, ethicists, data scientists, and business owners who review AI models to ensure safety, accuracy, and fairness before their deployment. The guiding principles of reliability, quality, fairness, accountability, transparency, privacy, security, and continuous improvement anchor our RAI program. It is these guiding principles that prohibit our businesses from using AI solutions to make medical necessity determinations. Our businesses can use AI tools safely and responsibly to accelerate approvals and ensure patients get more timely and appropriate care.

Our RAI Board ensures that we measure, identify, and mitigate potential bias or risk of unintended harm during the development of AI solutions. Policies set by our RAI Board define the testing and evaluation required prior to safe and responsible deployment of our AI applications. Resources for RAI include strategic guidelines, data custodianship and privacy principles, industry best practices, internal training, external learning resources, and governance and advisory boards.

Deploying AI Solutions to Make Health Care Work Smarter

We strongly believe that AI, when used safely and responsibly, can be a force for good in health care, leading to better, smarter care. We are focused on AI solutions to:

- simplify administrative workflow and help solve long-standing, time-consuming, and burdensome business processes;
- personalize the health care experience and enable digital-first health benefits, care delivery, and other health care transaction services; and
- bring the latest medical knowledge, patient history and outcomes data to clinicians in an effort to reduce burnout.

We're using AI solutions to improve value of care, improve the patient care experience, empower clinicians to better treat patients, and simplify administrative workflow.

Find and Price Care Tool

When members use our Find and Price Care tool, which is empowered by AI, they can quickly search and find the highest quality, lowest cost, and closest proximity in-network care provider. This AI solution informs patients of the costs they may incur to see a given provider, as well as sharing the provider's location, availability, and quality data.

Early Detection Tool

Our Early Detection tool uses AI to help identify members and support providers in assessing the best course of action in a timely manner. The clinician reviews patient history and visit summaries stored in a secured database. AI analyzes patient history against clinical guidelines and identifies evidence that may indicate an undiagnosed condition or increased disease risk. Use of this tool empowers the clinician to improve his/her accuracy in predicting emerging or undiagnosed risk, and allows for earlier

interventions and treatments, while also reducing provider burden and creating potential time savings.

High-Risk Patient Follow-Up Tool

For high-risk patients who visit the emergency room or are admitted to the hospital, our High-Risk Patient Follow-up AI solution can support the patient with a follow-up call. For example, the high-risk patient is discharged from the emergency room. The AI tool then flags the patient is at elevated risk, which then prompts a follow-up call from the clinician. This AI solution improves member engagement; it provides referrals to behavioral care; and it recommends members services and connects patients with community services.

We thank you for this opportunity to inform President Trump's AI Action Plan. We appreciate being able to share our views around safely and responsibly deploying AI solutions to make health care work smarter for everyone. We ask to be a resource to the Trump Administration as questions arise around how to responsibly, safely, and effectively leverage AI technology to improve Americans' health care experience, simplify administrative workflow and produce meaningful financial savings to the health care system.

Sincerely,

Rahul Bhotika (03/14/2025 10:25 PDT)

Rahul Bhotika, PhD
Chief AI Officer